18:12 VIRAR FAST PF 3

Mumbai Local

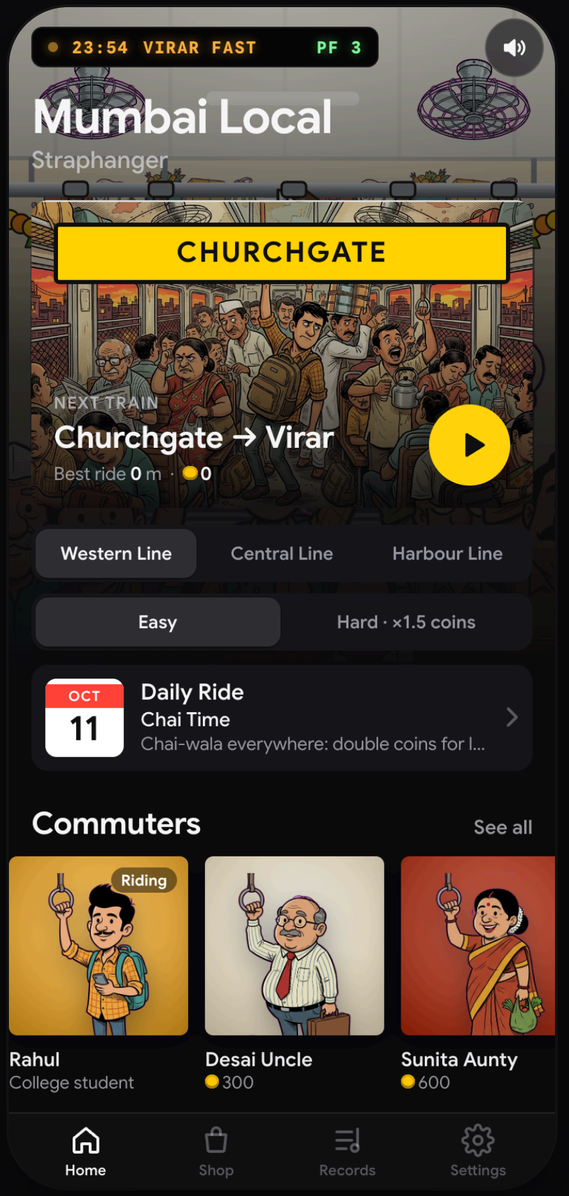
Straphanger

A balance game for phones. It's 6:12 pm on the Virar fast, the compartment is full, and you have **one overhead strap** and two thumbs to stay on your feet. Version 1.3.1.

PLAY IN YOUR PHONE'S BROWSER

mumbailocalgame.github.io

No install, no sign-in · English, हिन्दी, मराठी





THE CORE OF THE GAME

44°, and the uncle's tiffin is right there.

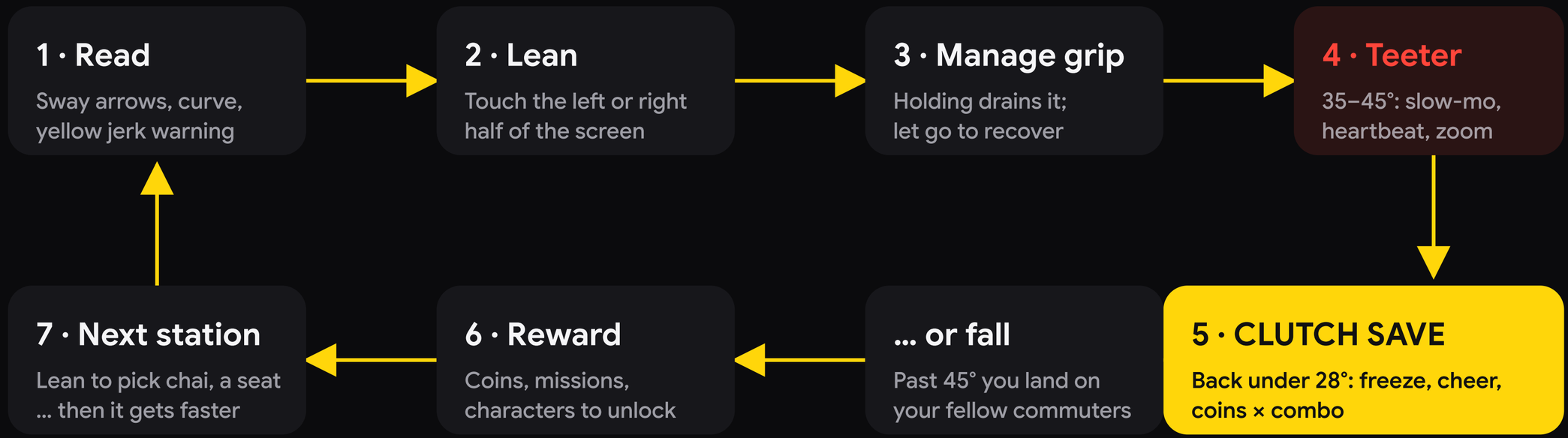
Anyone who has ridden a Mumbai local knows the second when the train lurches, your feet slide, and one leather strap is all that keeps you upright.

The whole game is built around that second. The train shoves you to the red end of the gauge, time slows, a heartbeat starts, the crowd gasps, and then **you pull yourself back**: a freeze-frame, your face breaks into relief and your neighbours cheer. That's the **CLUTCH SAVE**.

Every system in this document exists to make that moment happen more often, feel fairer, land harder, or be worth sharing.

CORE LOOP · ONE CYCLE EVERY 2–4 SECONDS

Read the sway. Lean against it. Survive the edge.



Outer loop: each ride ends in a fall. The game-over sheet shows how far along the Western line you got, your coins and finished missions, and one tap starts the next ride.

HOW IT PLAYS

Two halves of a screen. One strap.

Left half	Lean left (push back against a train swaying right). Also how you pick items at stations.
Right half	Lean right
Both halves	Brace: you stop steering but steady yourself, at double the grip cost
The gauge	Green within ±25°, yellow to 35°, red to 45°. Past 45° you fall (52° in Easy mode).
Grip ring	Blue inner ring. It drains while you hold and refills when you let go. Run out and your hand slips for a moment.



Arrow keys or A/D work on desktop. A short interactive tutorial (about 10 seconds) runs on first launch.

MAKING THE SAVE LAND

What happens in the two seconds around a save.

−0.6 s	Yellow edge + rail "tick" warn which side the jerk comes from
Past 36°	Time drops to 68%, camera pushes in, heartbeat speeds up
Past 43°	The crowd gasps; your character shouts "Arre arre arre!"
The save	0.12 s freeze-frame, rising chord, relief face, neighbours punch the air and say "Bach gaya!"
Combo	Saves within 12 s chain ×2, ×3. Coins and the chord's pitch climb
After the fall	Your best save replays in slow motion. One tap shares it as a video







DECISIONS, NOT JUST REACTIONS

Lean to choose.

At every station two items appear, one on each side. Lean toward one for 0.9 s to take it: the same move that keeps you upright, now with a cost.

Cutting chai	Grip refilled; drains at half speed for 10 s
Newspaper	6 s of calm: the train pushes you 45% less
Headphones	The next ride event is ignored
A seat (every 3rd stop)	Sit for 6 s, rest your grip, earn coins
Door or middle	Chosen before the ride: the door is windier but pays ×1.5 coins

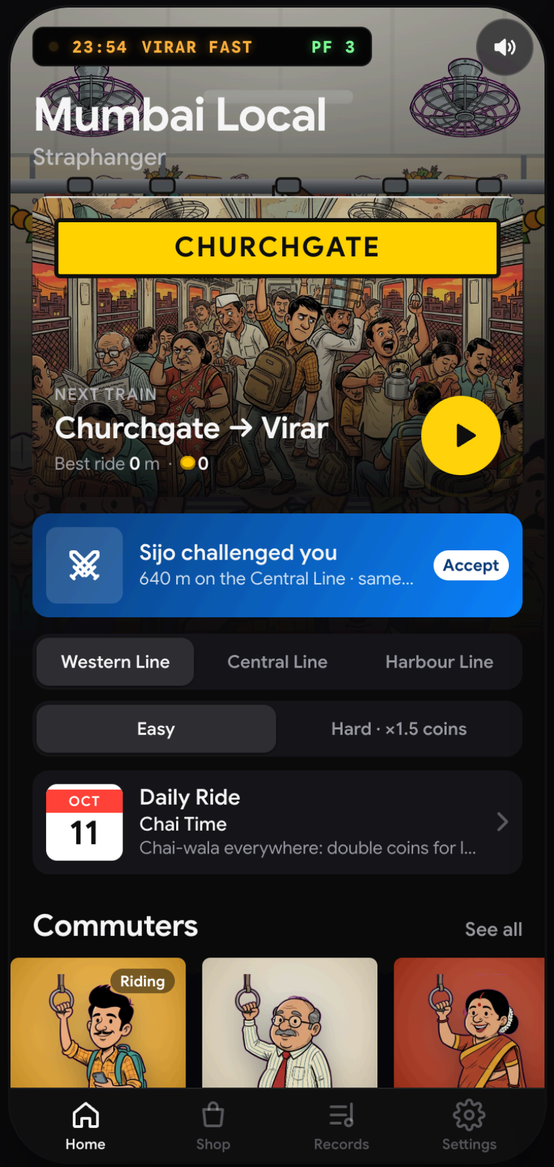
SOCIAL

Send your ride. Race their ghost.

Every ride is generated from a seed. **Challenge a friend** packs that seed, your distance and a compressed trace of your lean into one link that you send over WhatsApp.

Your friend gets the same train: the same curves, jerks and events, with a faint ghost of you leaning beside them. They see "You passed Sijo!" when they get past your distance.

No server or account is needed. A global Daily Ride leaderboard is built and only needs an online database switched on.





PROGRESSION & TUNING

Gentler first minute, more saves.

Simulated player	Before tuning	v1.3
Novice: median first ride	19.9 s	**22.1 s**
Novice: slowest quarter	13.3 s	**19.0 s**
Rides with a clutch save	47%	**64–68%**
Saves per ride (average player)	0.72	**1.50**

300 seeded rides per profile. Changes: the first 40 s start at 45% intensity, the first jerk waits 3.5 s, grip drains 20% slower, and the save window widened (pass 36°, recover under 28°). These are simulated players; real playtests come next (page 14).

3 lines

Western, Central (more curves, the Thane hills), Harbour (rougher jerks, the Vashi creek).

Daily Ride

One seeded ride for everyone, with a twist; +50 coins and a streak.

Commuters

4 illustrated characters with different stats: balance, grip, reflexes and coins.

Streaks & festivals

A daily streak counter. Festival weeks add marigold torans, lanterns and ×1.2 coins.

ART DIRECTION

Inspired by Mario Miranda's Bombay.

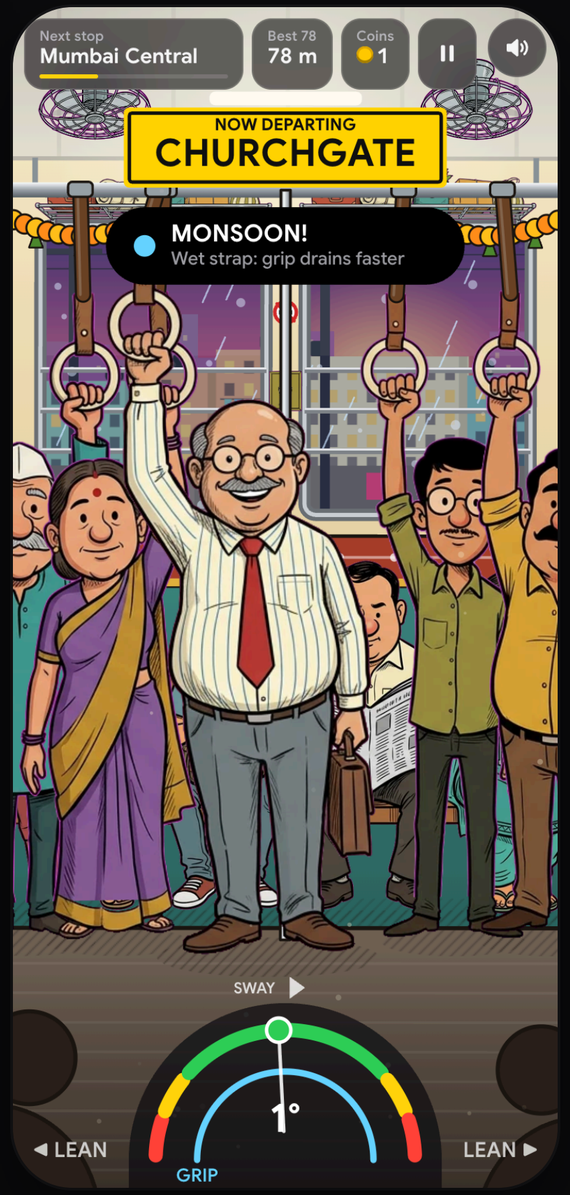
Mario Miranda drew Mumbai and Goa as packed, kind, ridiculous crowds. We borrowed his **way of seeing**, not his drawings:

Ink line	Every figure outlined in warm black, with flat colour and light texture
A living rig	Each commuter bends at the hips, the arm hinges at the shoulder, the strap slides on the rail and the feet step and stumble
Caricature	Round noses, dot eyes, bushy brows that do the acting: they glare, cheer and doze
Crowd	A second row of heads squeezed between your neighbours; everyone reacts to you
Palette	Ochre, brick, teal and cream, with station-board yellow as the only bright accent

Characters, bench, posters and props were generated with Figma AI in this style, then cut into a moving rig by our own script (tools/process_art.py). The train, sky and UI are drawn in code. No artist's work is traced or copied.







THE WORLD

Drawn from the Western line.

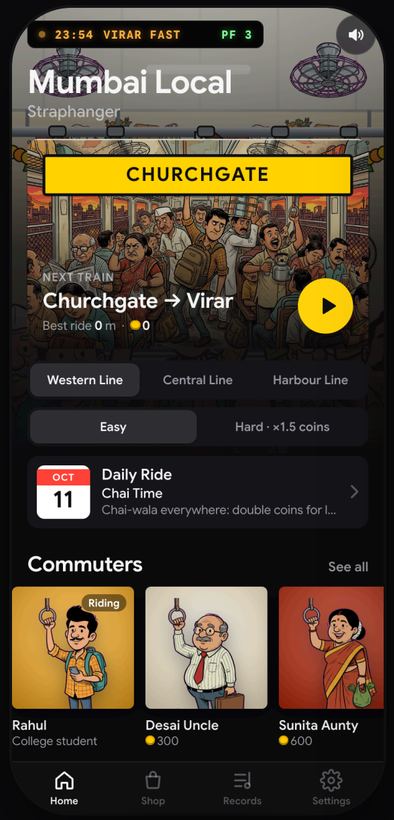
Details taken from real Mumbai locals:

- Backpacks worn on the chest
- Barred windows
- Caged ceiling fans
- Yellow station boards
- Black water tanks on chawl roofs
- Laundry lines
- The chai-wala's steel kettle
- A white Gandhi topi
- Sarees with a pallu
- Evening sky over the chawls
- Marigold torans in festival weeks
- Akash kandil lanterns at Diwali

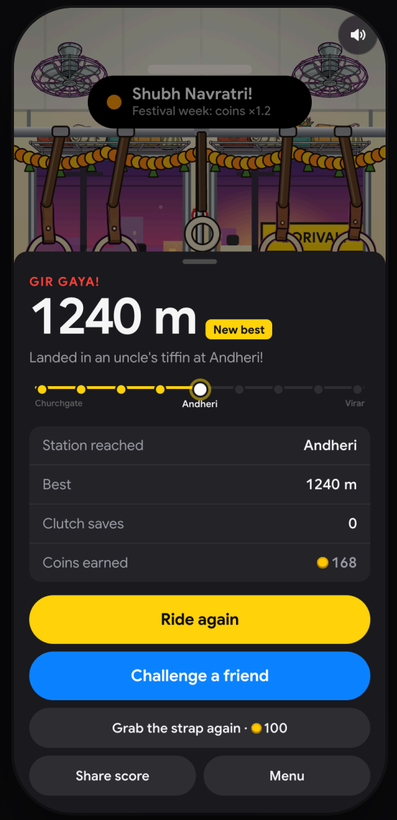
Three real lines: the Virar fast (Churchgate to Virar), Central (CSMT to Kalyan) and Harbour (CSMT to Panvel). Station names change script with the language.

INTERFACE

A phone app you already know, with railway signage.







Familiar patterns. Large titles, slide-up sheets, iOS switches and a tab bar, on a dark music-app style home with a round play button.

Full-screen shop. Each illustrated character gets a large card with stat bars for balance, grip, reflexes and coins.

It moves. Springy presses, a ticking departure board, count-up results, confetti on a new best, and soft tap sounds.

SOUND, VOICE & HAPTICS

Synthesised in the browser. Zero audio files.

Clack-clack

Paired rail-joint clicks that tighten as the train speeds up.

Heartbeat & gasp

A heartbeat from 35°, a crowd gasp near the edge, a relieved sigh on the save.

Voice lines

"Next station: Dadar." and "Bach gaya!" spoken by the phone's own Hindi, Marathi or English voice.

The save chord

A rising arpeggio, a semitone higher for every step of the combo.

Dhol + shehnai

A dhol groove and a reedy lead in a Bhairav-flavoured scale, faster each station.

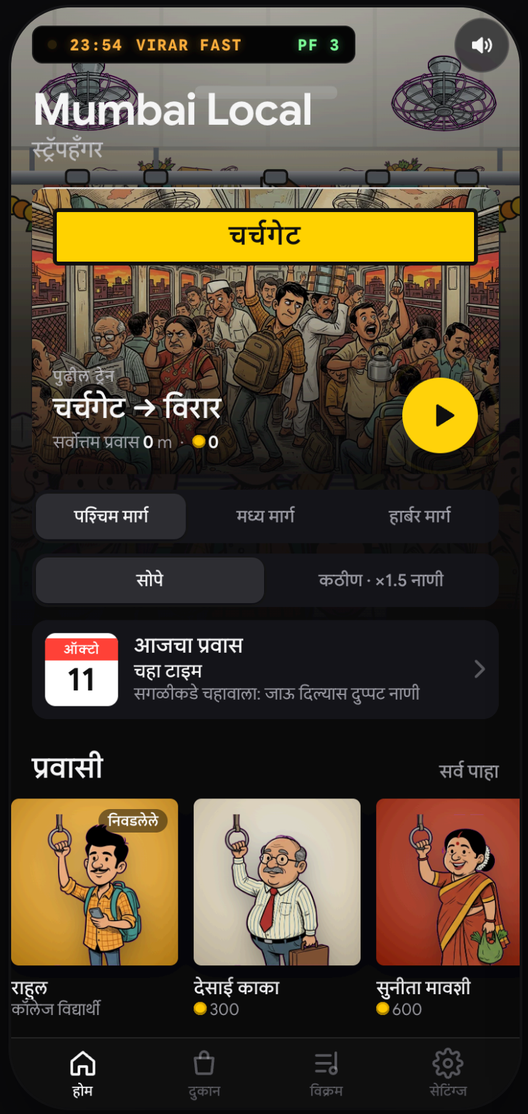
Haptics

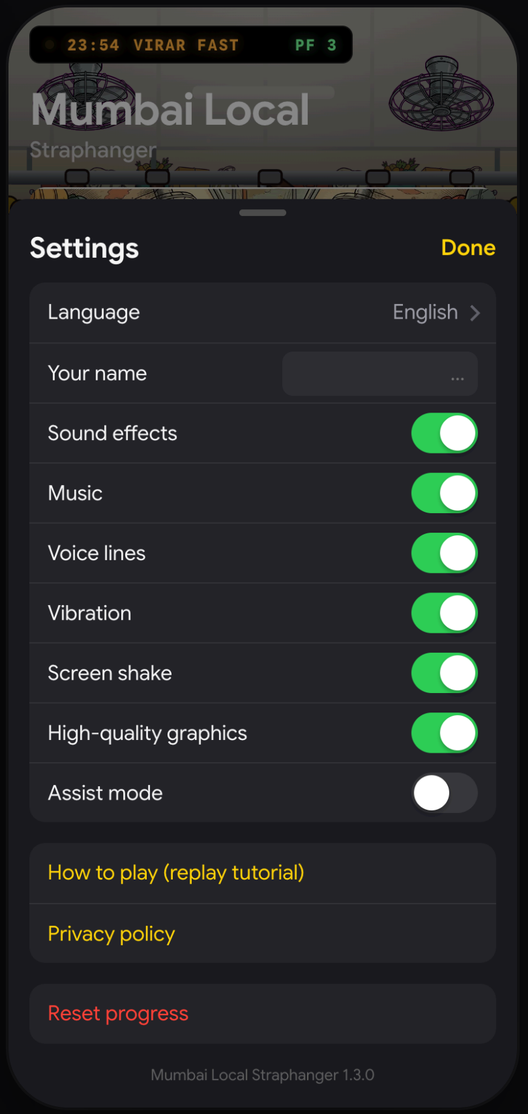
Taps for jerks and buttons, a heavier pulse for saves, falls and unlocks.

TECHNOLOGY & ACCESSIBILITY

One web app, any phone.

Rendering	HTML5 Canvas 2D at 60 fps, physics in fixed 1/120 s steps, devicePixelRatio-aware
Input	Multi-touch tracked per finger, cleared on blur/background so nothing gets stuck
Light	No external libraries; code ~165 KB plus ~125 KB of fonts. Add to Home Screen on the web; fully offline in the app builds
Languages	English, हिन्दी, मराठी, picked from the phone's language
Comfort	Easy mode (wider zones), and shake, vibration, voice, music and graphics toggles
Replays	Canvas recorded with MediaRecorder; rides are seeded and replayable

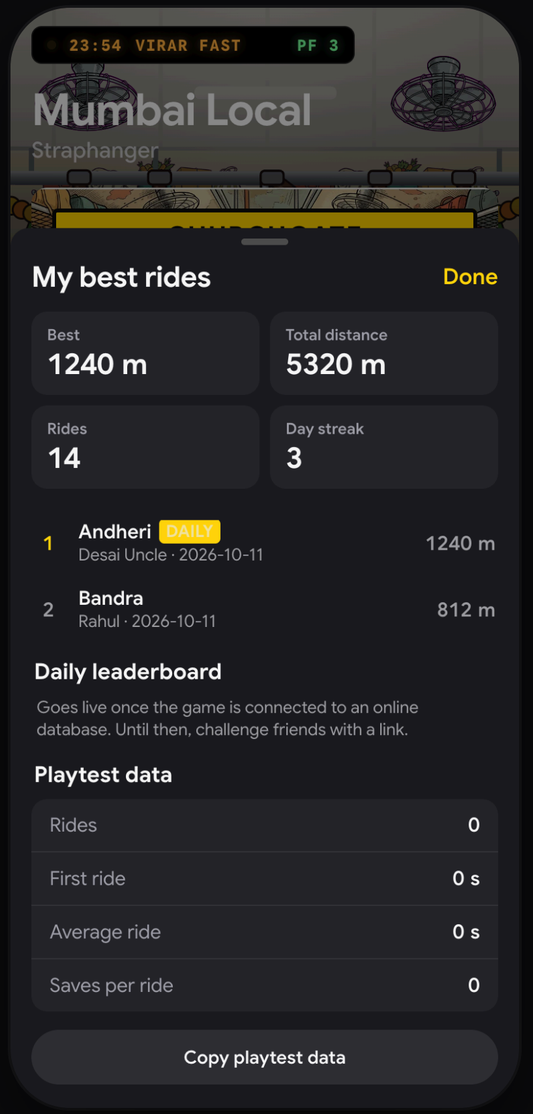




PLAYTESTING PLAN & WHAT'S NEXT

Next: ten real commuters.

Built in	A playtest recorder (Records screen): rides, first-ride length, average ride, saves per ride. One tap copies it to share
Targets	First ride ≥ 25 s; most riders get a save without being told; "Ride again" tapped ≥ 70% of the time
Leaderboard	Global Daily Ride board: screen is built, needs an online database (Firebase) switched on
Real recordings	A recorded horn, station announcement and crowd from an actual local, replacing synth
Native review	Hindi and Marathi text checked by native speakers



CHURCHGATE → VIRAR

Hold on tight.

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Open it on a phone, tap the yellow play button, and hold the left or right half of the screen.

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